controversial military campaign: public criticism, he argued, would damage the war effort.[22]

"Now there is no opposition, there is no Likud and Alignment [a now-defunct center-left bloc]. There is no religious and secular, rich and poor… now all of us are one, in uniforms. Now we are shooting. Quiet."

In fact, there was opposition. Anti-war protests started almost immediately. On 5 July, less than a month into the fighting, a relatively new group called Peace Now organized an anti-war rally in Tel Aviv. About 100,000 people turned up—then equal to one-third of the city's population. "They called for the removal of Defense Minister Ariel Sharon and an end of the war," the Jewish Telegraphic Agency reported. "Speakers urged the government not to order an attack on PLO forces holding out in west Beirut."[23] The protests would continue for months, and grew in intensity after the Sabra and Shatila massacre in September 1982, in which the Israeli army stood idle while its Lebanese Christian allies murdered hundreds of Palestinians in and around a Beirut refugee camp. Peace Now called for another demonstration in Tel Aviv on 25 September. It drew 400,000 protesters, which at the time represented a tenth of Israel's population.

Critics denounced the conflict in Lebanon as *milkhamat breirah*, a "war of choice", contrasting it with the wars of necessity in 1967 and 1973. Another new group, Yesh Gvul ("there is a limit"—*gvul* also means "border"), urged combat soldiers to sign a pledge not to serve in occupied Lebanon. About 3,000 of them ultimately did, and dozens were court-martialed for refusing to obey orders.

Peace Now and its allies did not bring peace, then or now. But the anti-war efforts of the 1980s created a "peace camp", one that questioned not just Israel's tactics but the entire foundation of its security policies. They would use their newfound clout a decade later to help Yitzhak Rabin implement the Oslo Accords, despite fierce political opposition. They made peace the defining issue in Israeli politics over the coming decade.

For fifty-one days in the summer of 2014, Israel was again at war. It was the second-longest war in the country's history, only behind the 1948 battle for independence, which pitted a nascent state against the combined forces of more than a half-dozen Arab nations. By 2014 the balance of power had been reversed: the most powerful army in the Middle East fought a motley collection of militants armed with rudimentary rockets and mortars, a network of underground attack tunnels, and at least one suicide donkey.